***Board 1***
North Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K Q 9 8 3<br>♥ 2<br>♦ A K<br>♣ K Q J 8 | |
| ♠ 10 5<br>♥ 8 6 3<br>♦ 10 9 6 5 4<br>♣ A 9 6 | | ♠ 6<br>♥ A J 10 9 7<br>♦ Q J 7 3<br>♣ 10 4 2 |
| | ♠ J 7 4 2<br>♥ K Q 5 4<br>♦ 8 2<br>♣ 7 5 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♦ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♣[2] |
| Pass | 5♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

***Board 2***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 6 4<br>♥ K J 9<br>♦ A K Q J 9<br>♣ K Q | |
| ♠ K 9 8 7 5<br>♥ 7 4<br>♦ 7 6 5 4<br>♣ A 6 | | ♠ Q 10 2<br>♥ 5 3 2<br>♦ 8 2<br>♣ 9 8 5 3 2 |
| | ♠ J 3<br>♥ A Q 10 8 6<br>♦ 10 3<br>♣ J 10 7 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH makes a positive 3♥ response to NORTH's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

NORTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the SOUTH hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

***Board 3***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 7
♥ Q J 4 2
♦ K Q 8 6
♣ A 5

♠ 10 8 3
♥ A 10 5 3
♦ J 9 7 3
♣ 10 8

♠ J 6 5 4 2
♥ 9 8 7
♦ 10 5 2
♣ 6 4

♠ K Q
♥ K 6
♦ A 4
♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1NT | Pass | 4♣ |
| Pass | 4♠ | Pass | 6NT |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by North
Lead: ♠4

When NORTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells SOUTH that 6NT can surely be made. NORTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But SOUTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

SOUTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and NORTH admits to just two Aces.

So SOUTH settles for the small slam.

***Board 4***
North Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 9 5 2<br>♥ A J 7 4 3<br>♦ A Q<br>♣ 9 8 | |
| ♠ 8<br>♥ Q 10<br>♦ J 9 6 5 4 2<br>♣ Q J 3 2 | | ♠ 10 7<br>♥ 9 8 6 2<br>♦ 10 8<br>♣ 10 7 6 5 4 |
| | ♠ A K Q 6 4 3<br>♥ K 5<br>♦ K 7 3<br>♣ A K | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♥ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 7NT |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

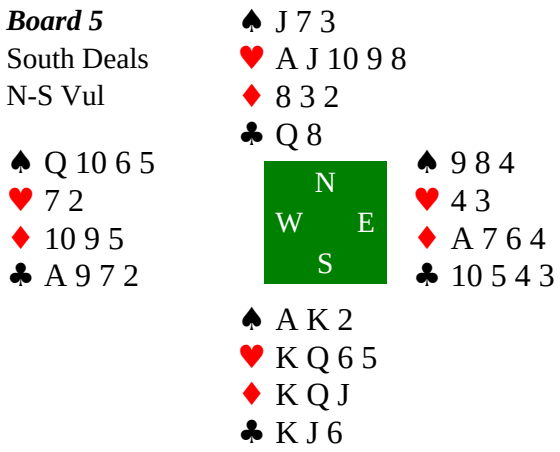
7NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When NORTH supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that NORTH has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that NORTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

***Board 5***
South Deals
N-S Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♦[2] | Pass | 5♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by North
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.